

# Input Content (IC)

Score: 1/5 — Serious concern | Confidence: high

Benchmark: ASAP++ | Context: Qatari and Arab High School Arabic Essay Writers (Grades 10–12)

**Input Content definition:** Whether individual datapoint content is culturally and contextually appropriate for the target region.

Each section below is followed by an evidence table. Three types of evidence are cited: [QN] — verbatim quotes extracted from the benchmark paper; [WEB-N] — web sources consulted during assessment; [DN] / [DATASET-DN] — sampled datapoints from the benchmark dataset, with an interpretation note.

## Justification

The benchmark's input instances are ~13,000 essays written entirely by native English-speaking US students in Grades 7–10 [Q3, Q10] across 8 prompts. The deployment targets Arabic-language Grade 10–12 students under the Qatar MOEHE curriculum (and other Arab curricula), writing to prompts grounded in Arab cultural, literary, and Islamic frames of reference [WEB-10, WEB-11]. There is no overlap in language, age band, nationality, curriculum, or cultural frame of reference. The anonymization scheme (e.g., @ORGANIZATION1, @PERSON1) was itself a source of interpretive difficulty even for the English annotators [Q41], and would compound transfer issues. No Arabic-language instances exist in the dataset.

| ID     | Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q3     | "The ASAP AEG dataset comprises of approximately 13,000 essays, written across 8 prompts. The essays were written by students of class 7 to 10. Each essay was evaluated by 2 evaluators. 6 out of the 8 prompts only have overall scores. Only 2 of them have scores for individual essay attributes, like content, organization, style, etc." (p.1) |
| Q10    | "All the essays were written by native English speaking children from classes 7 to 10." (p.2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Q41    | "One of the major problems that the annotators faced was the fact that all the essays were anonymized. Named entities, like The New York Times would be referred to as @ORGANIZATION1, Donald Trump would be referred to as @PERSON1, etc." (p.4)                                                                                                     |
| WEB-10 | Qatar MOE Arabic Language curriculum framework anchors Grades 1–12 writing standards ( <a href="http://www.sec.gov.qa/En/Education/Pages/GradeAndSubject.aspx">http://www.sec.gov.qa/En/Education/Pages/GradeAndSubject.aspx</a> )                                                                                                                    |
| WEB-11 | IMPACT-se review of Qatar 2025–2026 curriculum confirms Arabic Literature and politically/religiously contextualized content ( <a href="https://www.impact-se.org/wp-content/uploads/Qatar-Report-2026-final.pdf">https://www.impact-se.org/wp-content/uploads/Qatar-Report-2026-final.pdf</a> )                                                      |

## Strengths

- The dataset is openly available for non-commercial research use under CC-BY-SA [Q51, Q52], so it could in principle serve as a methodological reference (not a content reference) for designing an Arabic counterpart.

| ID  | Evidence                                                                                                                        |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q51 | "The resource is available online at <a href="https://cfilt.iitb.ac.in/~egdata/">https://cfilt.iitb.ac.in/~egdata/</a> ." (p.5) |
| Q52 | "The resource is available for non-commercial research use under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike License." (p.5)    |

## Checklist

### Checklist item definitions:

| ID   | Assessment Question                                                        |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| IC-1 | Do inputs require region-specific cultural/geographic/dialectal knowledge? |
| IC-2 | Does culturally sensitive content align with target culture?               |
| IC-3 | Flag inputs assuming Western-specific knowledge                            |
| IC-4 | Regional annotator recruitment for culturally sensitive instances          |
| IC-5 | Document content issues harming content validity                           |

## Checklist responses:

**IC-1:** Yes — Arab high school essay tasks require knowledge of Arabic literary tradition, Islamic ethical framing, classical rhetorical conventions (أصناف / أغالب), and country-specific civic content [WEB-11, cultural\_norms\_notes]. None of this is present in the benchmark inputs [Q10].

**IC-2:** No — the benchmark inputs are US student essays on US-curriculum prompts [Q3, Q10]; there is no alignment with Qatari/Arab cultural framing, Islamic values, or Arabic rhetorical norms.

**IC-3:** Yes — all benchmark inputs require Western-specific knowledge (US topics, English-language conventions, US-anonymized named entities like '@PERSON1' standing for figures such as Donald Trump [Q41]) that does not transfer to Arab student writers.

**IC-4:** INSUFFICIENT DOCUMENTATION — the benchmark documentation does not address recruiting regional annotators for re-validation; this would be a recommended remediation step.

**IC-5:** Content issues are categorical: zero Arabic-language data, zero Arab student writers, zero culturally-anchored prompts. This is a complete content validity violation for the deployment.

| ID     | Evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| WEB-3  | QAES annotated Qatari argumentative writing with trait-specific conventions appropriate to Qatari context (https://www.mdpi.com/2306-5729/10/9/148)                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| WEB-11 | IMPACT-se review of Qatar 2025–2026 curriculum confirms Arabic Literature and politically/religiously contextualized content (https://www.impact-se.org/wp-content/uploads/Qatar-Report-2026-final.pdf)                                                                                                                                               |
| WEB-12 | LAILA used annotators trained on Arab high school writing — example of appropriate annotator profile for this deployment (https://arxiv.org/abs/2512.24235)                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## Information Gaps

- The benchmark does not document any provision for non-English content, so it is structurally unable to support Arabic input.

## Requires Expert Verification

- Specific Qatar/Arab essay prompt corpora that could substitute as content anchors (LAILA and QAES are candidates per [WEB-12, WEB-3]).

## Remediation

**Gap 1: Benchmark essays are English US Grade 7–10 student writing; deployment requires Arabic Grade 10–12 student writing under Arab curricula.**

**Recommendation:** Replace ASAP++ entirely as a content reference. Use LAILA (7,859 essays) [WEB-12] as the primary corpus and QAES/QCAW [WEB-3] as the Qatari-anchored validation set; collect new student writing from Qatar MOEHE schools via the Qeducation LMS [WEB-15, WEB-17].

| ID     | Evidence                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>WEB-15</b> | Qeducation LMS (CYPHER) supports Arabic-language interface — relevant target platform for natural-language Arabic feedback delivery ( <a href="https://www.cypherlearning.com/blog/k-20/qatar-march-workshop-recap-empowering-students-teachers-and-parents-with-digital-technology-for-learning">https://www.cypherlearning.com/blog/k-20/qatar-march-workshop-recap-empowering-students-teachers-and-parents-with-digital-technology-for-learning</a> ) |
| <b>WEB-17</b> | Official 'Qatar Education' mobile app provides RTL Arabic delivery channel ( <a href="https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=app.qeducation.edu.gov.qa">https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=app.qeducation.edu.gov.qa</a> )                                                                                                                                                                                                              |